

Trainings ▾

General Information

⚠ CAUTION ⚠

Do not exceed governed engine speed when operating engine brakes. Engine damage can occur. The engine brakes are designed to assist the vehicle's service brakes to slow down the vehicle.

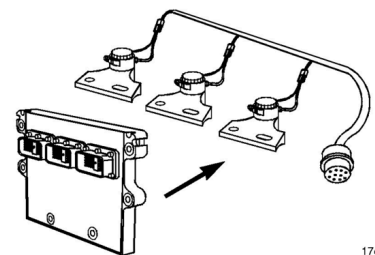
©Cummins Inc.

Signature and ISX engines are equipped with the Intebrake™ system (engine brakes).

Engine brakes use the energy of engine compression to provide vehicle retardation by converting the engine to an energy-absorbing device to reduce vehicle speed. This is accomplished by a hydraulic circuit that opens the exhaust valves near the end of the compression stroke.

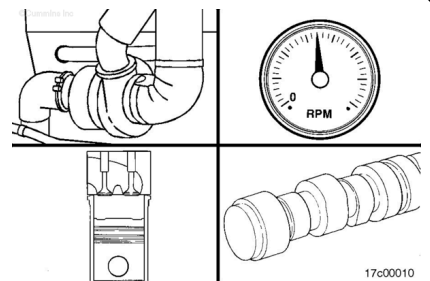
The ISX CM870 product and newer use the added benefit of the variable geometry turbocharger to assist in engine braking.

©Cummins Inc.



17c00015

The amount of braking power available on this engine is up to 600 hp. Braking power is managed by the Intebrake™ system (engine brakes).



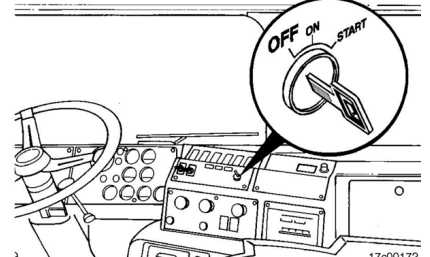
17c00010

⚠ CAUTION ⚠

Do not operate the engine if the engine brakes will not deactivate. To do so will cause severe engine damage.

If the engine brakes will **not** shut off, shut off the engine immediately, and contact a Cummins Authorized Repair Facility.

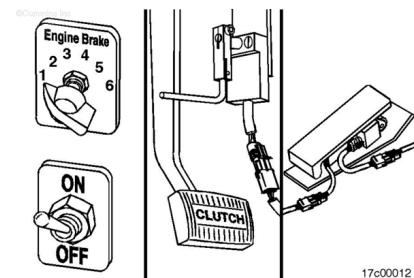
©Cummins Inc.



17c000172

Engine brake controls consist of the following:

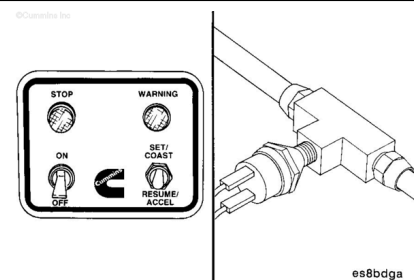
- A six-position or three-position selector switch
- An on/off switch
- A clutch switch
- A throttle sensor
- A service brake pressure switch.



17c00012

Other switches for cruise control that affect engine brake operations are:

- Cruise control on/off and set/resume switches (if the engine brakes in cruise control feature is turned off)
- Service brake air pressure switch.

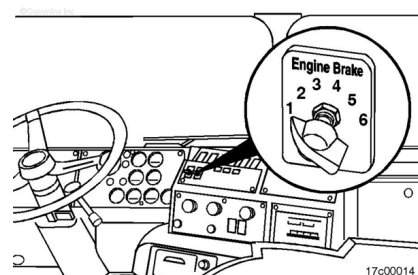


es8bdga

Engine brakes can operate while cruise control is turned on. The electronic feature, fan control engine braking, can be enabled to turn the fan on during engine braking. This increases the parasitic load on the engine during braking. Refer to Programmable Features in this section.

Note : Some OEMs choose to use a three-position switch.

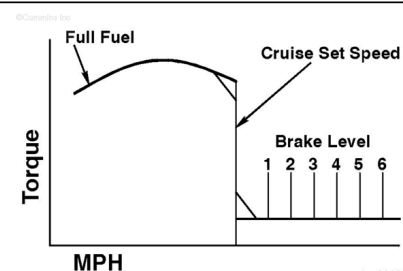
The six-position selector switch is located next to the on/off switch in the cab, and allows you to select the retarding power from one to six brakes.



17c00014

The engine brake level specifications:

- Position No. 1 = 17-percent engine braking power.**
- Position No. 2 = 33-percent engine braking power.**
- Position No. 3 = 50-percent engine braking power.**
- Position No. 4 = 67-percent engine braking power.**
- Position No. 5 = 83-percent engine braking power.**
- Position No. 6 = 100-percent engine braking power.**



17c00033

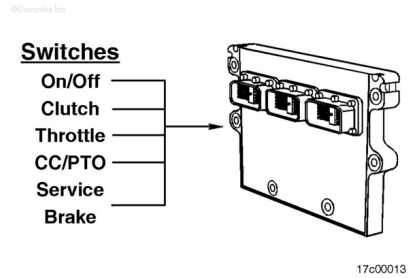
Note : For OEMs that use a three-position switch, the brake level specifications are:

- Position No. 1 = 33-percent engine braking power.**
- Position No. 2 = 67-percent engine braking power.**
- Position No. 3 = 100-percent engine braking power.**

For ISX CM870 and newer products, the engine brake select switch does **not** always directly correlate to the number of engine brake solenoids that are activated. This is due to the added use of the variable geometry turbocharger to assist in engine braking and the use of **only** two engine brake solenoids.

Note : Any one of these switches can deactivate the engine brakes. If the engine brakes in cruise control feature is turned on, the cruise control switch, PTO switches, or both will **not** deactivate the engine brakes.

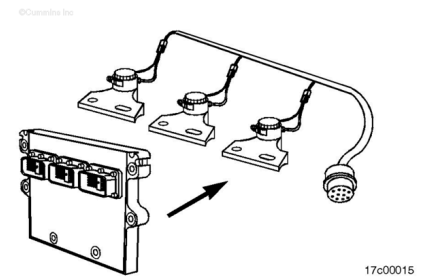
With the engine, signals from the on/off switch, the clutch switch, the throttle sensor, and the cruise control switch, PTO switches, or both are fed into the electronic control module.



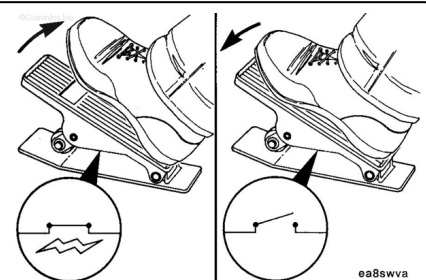
Note : Engine brakes can not be enabled:

The ECM then electronically enables or disables the engine brakes.

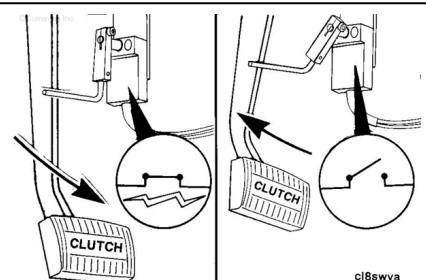
1. When cruise control is active, if the engine brakes in cruise control feature is turned off
2. When engine speed goes below 850 rpm or 30 mph
3. When an electronic fault code is active
4. When the clutch pedal is depressed
5. When the throttle pedal is depressed
6. When the PTO or remote PTO is active.



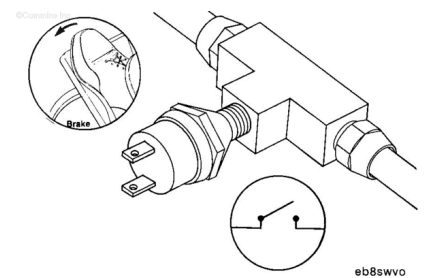
The throttle position sensor is part of the accelerator pedal assembly located in the cab and will deactivate the engine brakes when depressed.



The clutch switch uses the motion of the clutch linkage to deactivate the engine brakes when the clutch pedal is depressed. Depressing the clutch while in cruise control will disengage the cruise control.



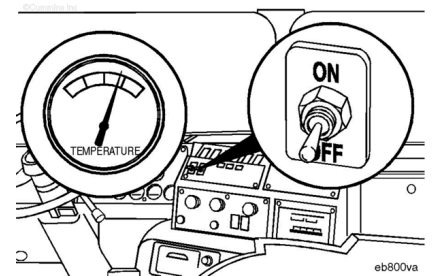
The service brake pressure switch is attached to the service brake air supply line.



Applying the service brakes while in cruise control will disengage the cruise control and enable the engine brakes.

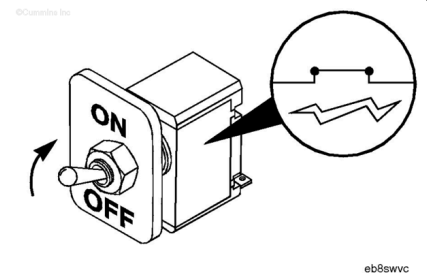
If the pedal-activated engine brake feature is enabled, the service brake pedal **must** be tapped before the engine brakes will be activated.

Idle the engine 3 to 5 minutes at approximately 1000 rpm to warm the engine before activating the engine brakes. Do **not** operate the engine brakes until the engine oil temperature is above 30°C [86°F].



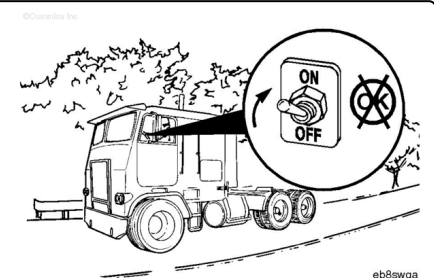
Note : See the “Tips for Operation” steps in this section for specific information about engine brake operation under certain road conditions.

To activate the engine brakes, switch the on/off switch to the ON position. Once activated, the operation of the engine brakes is fully automatic.



⚠ WARNING ⚠

Do not use the engine brakes while bobtailing or pulling an empty trailer. With the engine brakes in operation, wheel lockup can occur more quickly when the service brakes are applied, especially on vehicles with single-drive axles.

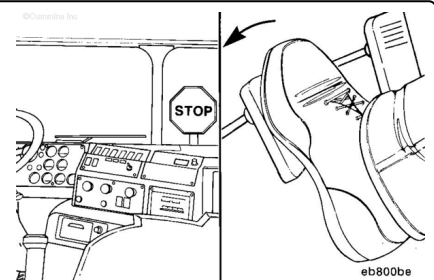


Make sure the engine brakes are switched to the OFF position when bobtailing or pulling an empty trailer.

⚠ CAUTION ⚠

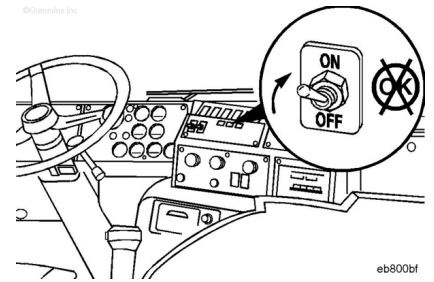
The engine brakes are designed to assist the vehicle's service brakes in slowing the vehicle to a stop.

Remember, service brakes will be required to bring the vehicle to a stop.

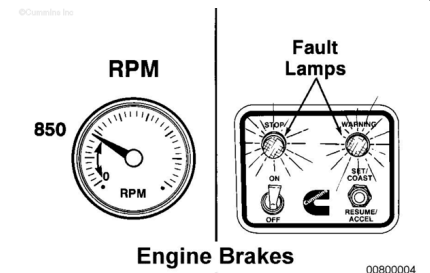


⚠ CAUTION ⚠

Do not use the engine brakes to aid clutchless gear shifting. This can cause the engine to stall or lead to engine damage.



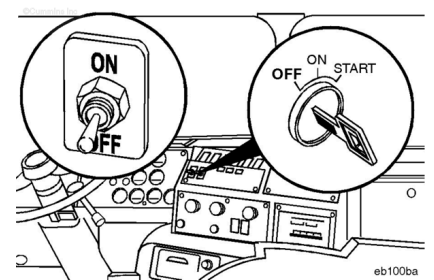
The ECM will disable the engine brakes when engine rpm is below 850 rpm, when an electronic fault code is active, or if the vehicle speed is less than the engine brake minimum vehicle speed parameter.



⚠ CAUTION ⚠

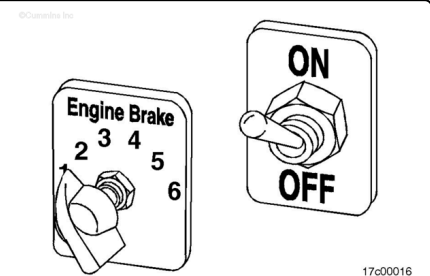
Do not operate the engine if the engine brakes will not deactivate. To do so will cause severe engine damage.

If the engine brakes will **not** shut off, shut off the engine immediately, and contact a Cummins Authorized Repair Facility.

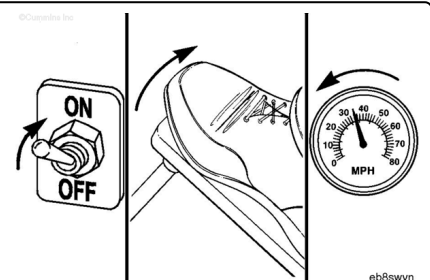


Tips for Operating on Level and Dry Pavement

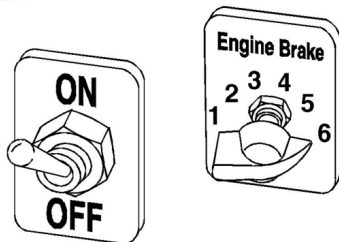
For operating on dry and relatively flat surfaces when greater retarding power is **not** required, you can select a lower position.



To reduce vehicle speed, put the engine brake on or off switch in the ON position. Remove your foot from the throttle and clutch pedal. The engine brakes will immediately begin to operate, slowing the vehicle.



For operation on dry pavement when maximum retarding power is required, select the No. 6 position.



17c00017

⚠ WARNING ⚠

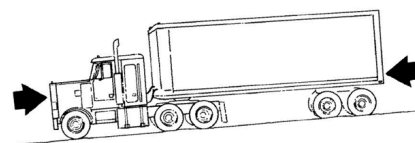
The safe control speed of a vehicle will vary with the size of the load, the type of load, the grade, and the road conditions.

Note : Always be prepared to use the vehicle service brakes for emergency stopping.

Tips for Operation on Grades with Dry Pavement

Vehicles equipped with properly operated engine brakes are capable of traveling downhill at slightly higher control speeds than vehicles **not** equipped with engine brakes.

©Cummins Inc.



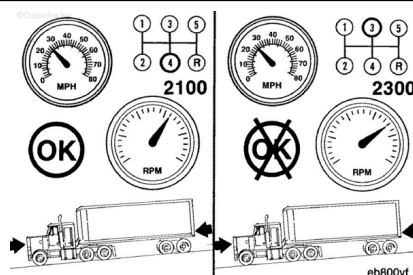
eb800ba

⚠ CAUTION ⚠

Never exceed governed engine speed as engine damage can occur.

Note : The optimum braking power of engine brakes is reached at rated engine speed, therefore, correct gear selection is critical.

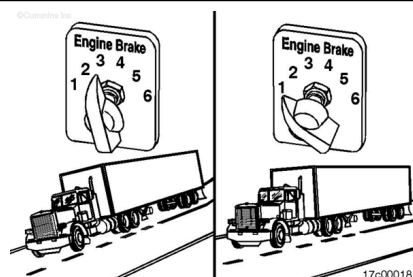
Once you have determined the safe speed for your vehicle, operate the engine brakes with the transmission in the lowest gear which will **not** cause the engine speed to exceed the rated engine speed.



eb800vf

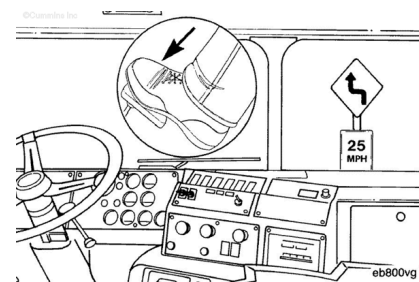
Note : Some OEMs choose to use a three-position switch.

The six-position selector switch can be used to vary braking power as road conditions change.



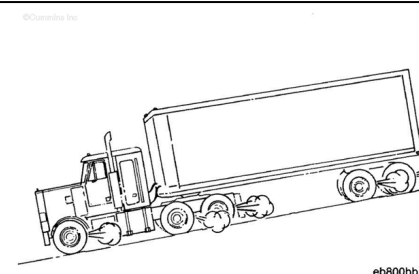
17c00018

Vehicle service brakes **must** be used when additional braking power is required.



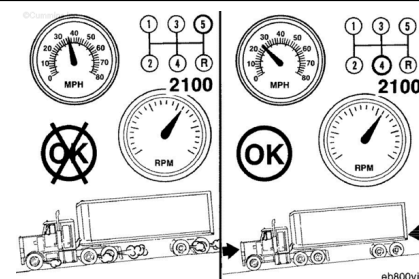
⚠ WARNING ⚠

Frequent use of the service brakes will cause them to heat up, which reduces the ability to slow or stop the vehicle.



Note : The longer or steeper the hill, the more important it is to use your engine brakes. Make maximum use of your engine brakes by gearing down and letting the engine brakes do the work.

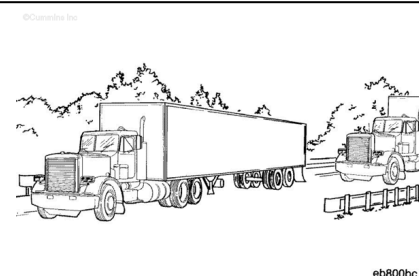
If frequent use of the vehicle service brakes is required, it is recommended that a slower control speed be used by selecting a lower transmission gear.



Tips for Operation on Slick Roads

⚠ CAUTION ⚠

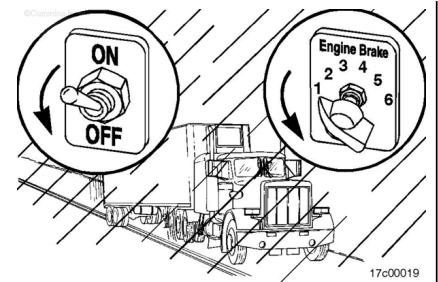
The operation of any vehicle is difficult to predict on slick roads. The first 10 to 15 minutes of rainfall are the most dangerous, as road dirt and oil mixed with rain create a very slippery surface.



Always allow for extra distance between your vehicle and other objects when using the service brakes or engine brakes on slick roads.

⚠ WARNING ⚠

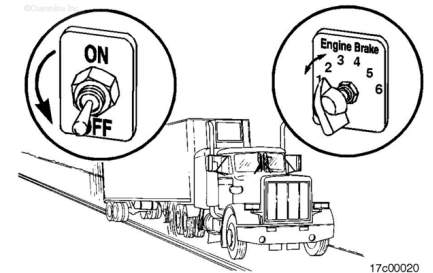
Using the engine brakes on wet or slippery roads can cause overbraking of the wheels, especially vehicles with light loads or single-drive axles. Stopping distance can actually increase, or the vehicle can skid or jackknife.



Reduce the retarding power, or turn off the engine brakes on slick roads.

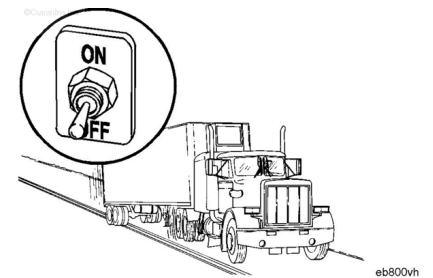
When driving on slick roads, start with the on/off switch in the OFF position and the six-position selector switch in the No. 1 or No. 2 position.

If your tractor is equipped with a twin-screw rear axle, use the power divider in the UNLOCKED position.

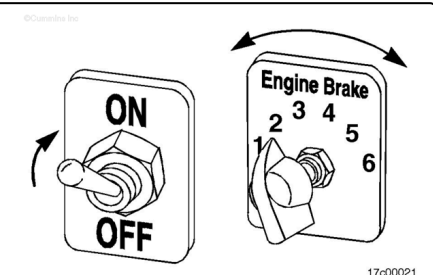


Remove your foot from the throttle to make sure that the vehicle will maintain traction with the retarding power of the engine alone.

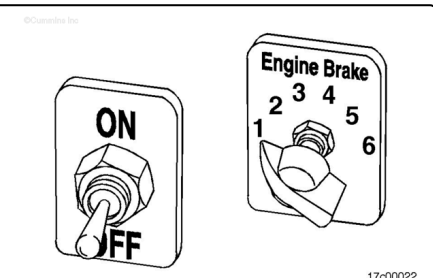
If the vehicle drive wheels begin to skid or there is a fishtailing motion, do **not** activate the engine brakes.



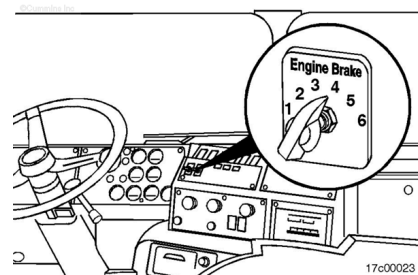
If traction is maintained and more braking power is required, you can select the next higher position on the six-position selector switch. Activate the engine brakes by switching the on - off switch to the ON position.



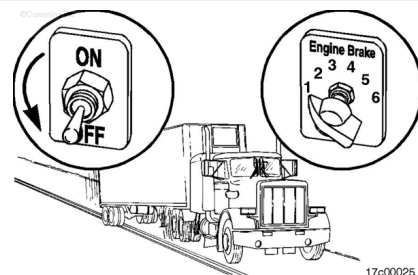
If the vehicle's drive wheels begin to skid or there is a fishtailing motion, switch the on/off switch to the OFF position.



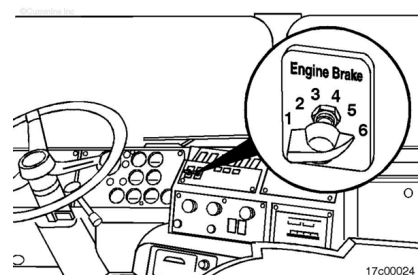
If traction is maintained when the engine brakes are activated and more braking power is required, move the six-position selector switch to the No. 3 or 4 position.



Again, if the vehicle has lost traction or there is a fishtailing motion, switch the on/off switch to the OFF position. Do **not** attempt to use the engine brakes in the No. 3 or 4 position.



Repeat the above procedures to select the No. 5 or 6 position on the selector switch.



Again, if the vehicle has lost traction or there is a fishtailing motion, switch the on/off switch to the OFF position. Do **not** attempt to use the engine brakes in the No. 5 or 6 position.

